

Parks Board Meeting April 21, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=30VdJL0llao
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Muncie Park and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, April 21, 2025

Report Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muncie Park and Recreation Board meeting to order on Tuesday, April 21, [00:00:12](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mark Ervin, Anna Powers, C.J. Johnson, Brad Marshall, and Ashley Wright.
 - **Members Absent:** (None noted in transcript)
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly designated by name, but leading the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:16](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the March meeting were **deferred to the May meeting** [00:00:50](#) due to a transition in secretarial staff (welcoming Grace as the new secretary).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:15 Programming Report <U+2013> Summer Events & Youth Programs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark (Programming Director)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mark highlighted upcoming summer programming, including the National Kids to the Park Day on May 16th at Westside Park **00:02:20**. He discussed the Muncie Teen Internship Program: interviews are complete, and 50 youth were selected (down from 100 last year due to budget constraints) **00:03:07**. New partnerships include "The Crossing" high school program for student work experience **00:04:37**, local basketball tournaments, and pickleball tournament discussions.
 - **Action & Resolution:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:07:23 Special Event Request: Shepherd<U+2019>s Heart and Hands Inc.**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark / Joseph (Representative)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The nonprofit requested the use of McCulloch Park (top of the Derby hill) on May 9th from 9:00 a.m. to noon for an annual community prayer event anticipating 50<U+2013>75 attendees **00:07:32**. They requested shelter usage, two porta-potties, and a metal stage with no fee/profit involved **00:08:58**.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Joseph spoke on behalf of the organization, noting the event brings pastors and community members together with no commercial agenda **00:08:44**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** to waive the fee structure and grant an in-kind donation for the event **00:11:19**.
- **00:12:27 Special Event Request: America<U+2019>s Hometown Band**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The band requested Westside Park on June 18th, July 16th, and August 20th (3:00 p.m. to 9:00 p.m.) for concert band performances, expecting 100 to 300 attendees **00:12:10**. Board members noted concerns regarding vague attendance projections and the lack of a defined security plan **00:12:31**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Tentatively held the dates** pending receipt of more definitive attendance figures and a security plan, to be revisited at the May meeting **00:13:13**.
- **00:14:02 Parks Department Operational Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Carl returned from an 8-week medical absence **00:18:57**. He clarified that cabin use policies are being updated: employee cabin rentals are discontinued by order of the mayor, but churches may continue to use cabins for peaceful repasts free of charge **00:15:18**. New shelters have been installed at the

top of the hill, Ball Park, and Allshire Park 00:17:25. The department currently operates with 12 total staff members (10 full-time, 2 part-time) 00:20:10.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no vote taken.
- **00:21:09 Prairie Creek Reservoir Report & Proposals**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Taylor provided operational updates: piers are on track for May 1st, mowing is ahead of schedule thanks to new equipment 00:21:31, and part-time staff roles have been combined for efficiency 00:22:18. A major shift this season is going **cashless** using an integrated point-of-sale system, keeping the Iron Ranger as the sole cash option for this transition year 00:23:31.
 - **Board Proposals Presented:**
 1. *Daily rental piers and temporary docking piers* 00:34:34.
 2. *New indoor event rental space* utilizing the old upstairs restaurant/patio area at the main office 00:37:02.
 3. *Non-motorized boat rentals* (kayaks, canoes, paddleboards), potentially funded via a Destination Muncie grant 00:39:57.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational and proposal presentation. Board members expressed general support and instructed Taylor to work with the legal team/insurance carrier on waivers and fee structures for review at the May meeting.
- **00:31:09 Special Event Request: Old National Bank Picnic**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Old National Bank requested Shelter 1 at the beach on June 27th from 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. for an employee picnic with 40-50 attendees 00:31:21. Because the headcount exceeds the shelter's stated capacity, it triggers an "event" status under park rules 00:31:53.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** (with Ashley Wright abstaining) 00:32:21.
- **00:33:51 Old Business: Tuhey Pool Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark / Board Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Significant progress has been made on Tuhey Pool. The sanitary district stepped in to repair infrastructure (valves, pumps, chlorinators) at a fraction of past contractor quotes 00:44:34. While the YMCA cannot manage the facility this year due to capacity constraints, local swimming community leaders have identified potential managers and lifeguards 00:45:10. The administration has pledged funding to open the facility around Memorial Day or shortly thereafter 00:46:41.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal vote taken.
- **00:48:15 Special Event Request: Holtzman Village Neighborhood Association**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The association requested Holtzman Park for a neighborhood park party on June 13th from 11:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. (rain date June

27th), anticipating 150 attendees, food trucks, and nonprofit booths 00:48:30. They requested a fee waiver, two trash toters, and two porta-potties 00:47:37.

- **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** for the event application and fee waiver 00:54:19.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:50:00 **Courtney (Southside Neighborhood Association President):**
 - Announced that the mural at Cooley Park is **officially finished** ahead of schedule (completed in about 2.5 weeks instead of 4) 00:57:56.
 - Invited the board and community to a ribbon-cutting ceremony and neighborhood meeting on **Tuesday, May 26th at 6:00 p.m.** at the park, featuring light appetizers 00:57:27.
 - Provided a brief update on the upcoming *Gus Macker* 3-on-3 basketball tournament, noting they are within the 90-day window, handling team registrations via Michigan, and actively seeking local sponsors and volunteers 00:59:32.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Next regular meeting scheduled for May.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially **adjourned by voice vote** 00:01:38 following a motion and second 00:01:35.

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